IGCSE ARABIC 0544 · PAPER 3 SPEAKING AND PAPER 4 WRITING

Exam-day survival sheet

دَلِيلُ يَوْمِ الامْتِحَانِ

⏱ Timings: Writing

Q1 Form	≈ 8 min · no empty boxes
Q2 Email / message	≈ 12 min · every bullet · 80–90 words
Q3 Extended	≈ 25 min = 3 plan + 20 write + 2 check

Extra time on the day? Spend it **checking**, not adding new risky sentences.

🗣 Timings: Speaking

Prep	Read every task · underline question words · plan first words
Role plays	Full sentence for every task · the **!** task is not on your card: listen
Conversation	Answer + reason + another time frame

🛟 Repair phrases: never leave a silence

عَفْوًا، هَلْ يُمْكِنُ أَنْ تُعِيدَ السُّؤَالَ؟	Sorry, could you repeat the question?
لَمْ أَفْهَمْ جَيِّدًا. هَلْ يُمْكِنُ أَنْ تَتَكَلَّمَ بِبُطْءٍ؟	I didn't quite understand. Could you speak slowly?
مَا مَعْنَى ...؟	What does ... mean?
لَحْظَةً مِنْ فَضْلِكَ ... دَعْنِي أُفَكِّرُ.	One moment please ... let me think.
أَقْصِدُ أَنَّ ... / بِعِبَارَةٍ أُخْرَى ...	I mean that ... / In other words ...
لَا أَتَذَكَّرُ الكَلِمَةَ، لَكِنَّهُ شَيْءٌ ...	I can't remember the word, but it's something ...
هٰذَا سُؤَالٌ صَعْبٌ، وَلٰكِنْ فِي رَأْيِي ...	That's a hard question, but in my opinion ...

To a female examiner: تُعِيدِي · تَتَكَلَّمِي · مِنْ فَضْلِكِ

🔎 Question-word decoder

أَيْنَ	where → place
مَتَى	when → time / day
كَيْفَ	how → way / transport
لِمَاذَا	why → لِأَنَّ
صِفْ / صِفِي	describe → adjectives
مَا رَأْيُكَ	opinion → أَظُنُّ أَنَّ
مَاذَا فَعَلْتَ	what did you do → PAST
خُطَطُكَ	your plans → سَـ FUTURE

🚀 Mark boosters

... لِأَنَّ ... · لِذٰلِكَ	because ... · so ...
... كُنْتُ ... أَمَّا الآنَ فَ	I used to ... but now ...
... سَوْفَ ... / فِي المُسْتَقْبَلِ	I will ... / in the future ...
... أَكْثَرُ ... مِنْ · بَيْنَمَا	more ... than · whereas
... صَحِيحٌ أَنَّ ... غَيْرَ أَنَّ	it's true that ... but ...
... لَوْ كُنْتُ ...، لَـ	if I were ..., I would ...

✅ The five-point writing check

1. **Every bullet** answered (plus greeting and closing in Q2).
2. **Verb endings:** who and when?
   ذَهَبْتُ · نَذْهَبُ · سَأَذْهَبُ
3. **Agreement:**
   بَيْتٌ كَبِيرٌ · مَدِينَةٌ كَبِيرَةٌ · حَقِيبَةٌ سَوْدَاءُ
4. **Numbers + nouns:**
   ثَلَاثُ سَاعَاتٍ · عِشْرُونَ طَالِبًا
5. **Three time frames** and linkers:
   لِأَنَّ · لٰكِنَّ · ثُمَّ

🌙 The night before and on the day

- Sleep early, eat breakfast and drink water.
- Pens, ID and a watch ready the night before.
- Read the **whole** question before you write a word.
- A short correct sentence beats a long broken one.
- Stuck? Use a repair phrase, breathe, and keep going.

رَبِّ اشْرَحْ لِي صَدْرِي ۝ وَيَسِّرْ لِي أَمْرِي

"My Lord, expand my chest and ease my task for me." (Ṭā Hā 20:25–26)

بِالتَّوْفِيقِ فِي الامْتِحَانِ! · Good luck in the exam!